

TABLE 3—REDUCED-FORM ESTIMATES OF EVACUEE SHARE OF ENROLLMENT IN GRADE ON INCUMBENT TEST SCORES: HOUSTON

All (1)	African American (2)	Boys (3)	Girls (4)	Bottom quartile (5)	2nd quartile (6)	3rd quartile (7)	Top quartile (8)	Placebo test (9)
<i>Panel A. Elementary</i>								
Math								
−0.29 (0.41)	−0.83 (0.55)	−0.14 (0.48)	−0.41 (0.41)	−0.73 (0.85)	−1.15** (0.51)	−0.99* (0.58)	0.73 (0.50)	−0.16 (0.89)
90,267	23,966	44,868	45,399	20,229	23,183	23,368	23,487	53,255
Reading/ELA								
−0.12 (0.40)	−0.73 (0.58)	−0.30 (0.49)	0.06 (0.44)	−0.42 (0.93)	0.12 (0.59)	0.14 (0.38)	0.18 (0.57)	−0.65 (1.28)
73,923	21,582	37,264	36,659	16,813	19,348	18,977	18,785	42,281
<i>Panel B. Middle/High</i>								
Math								
0.31 (0.35)	−0.05 (0.48)	0.21 (0.39)	0.41 (0.35)	0.20 (0.85)	−0.30 (0.39)	0.05 (0.30)	−0.27 (0.37)	−0.02 (0.45)
249,021	72,314	122,799	126,222	51,011	63,829	66,189	67,992	129,845
Reading/ELA								
0.66 (0.45)	0.55 (0.53)	0.53 (0.53)	0.75* (0.40)	0.10 (1.62)	0.22 (0.35)	−0.32 (0.35)	−1.07*** (0.33)	−0.30 (0.47)
250,808	72,641	123,639	127,169	50,089	65,660	66,940	68,119	130,310

Notes: Standard errors are provided in parentheses and clustered by school. Observation counts appear in the last row for each subject. Regressions cover 2003–2004 to 2006–2007 and include student’s race, gender, free/reduced price lunch status, grade-by-year fixed effects, school fixed-effects, and lagged achievement from the student’s most recent pre-Katrina lagged score interacted with indicators for the number of years between exams. TAKS scores are standard deviations of scale scores within grade and year using statewide means and standard deviations. When students have multiple scores for a single subject in a given year we use the lowest score. Placebo regressions are limited to pre-Katrina years and apply the 2005–2006 evacuee shares to 2004–2005 observations. Quartiles are determined using the most recent pre-Katrina score available and are within grade and year across the district. Elementary is defined as any student in grades 3–5. Middle/High is any student in grades 6–11.

***Significant at the 1 percent level.

**Significant at the 5 percent level.

*Significant at the 10 percent level.

infractions than similar incumbents initially and then more in 2006–2007, suggesting schools practiced leniency early on.

B. Reduced-Form Effects from the Inflow of Evacuees in Houston

In Table 3 we show the effect of evacuees on math and reading performance of their nonevacuee peers; i.e., the exogenous peer effects. Panels A and B present results for students in elementary grades (3–5) and middle and high grades (6–11), respectively. Column 1 reports estimates for the full sample, while columns 2, 3, and 4 report results of fully saturated models for African Americans, boys and girls. Columns 5–8 report results for incumbents in different parts of the districtwide incumbent achievement distribution based on pre-Katrina scores.

Roughly half of the estimates in Table 3 are negative and most are not statistically significant. This leads us to conclude that the large influx of evacuees (many of whom are low achieving) did not have detectable test score effects on average. The results do show negative and statistically significant effects on math for elementary students in